Staff Rota Policy

Harbour Health. Owner: Isla McGregor, Rota Coordinator. Approved by Nina Osei, Operations Director. Version 2.2, effective 1 October 2025, last updated 11 May 2026.

This policy sets out how rotas are planned, published and changed across Harbour's four clinics: Harbourside, Bedminster, Easton and Horfield. It applies to all rota'd staff, including reception, clinic support and bank staff. It does not cover office-based staff on fixed hours.

1. Shift patterns

Shift	Times	Clinics
Early	07:30 to 15:30	All four
Late	12:00 to 20:00 Monday to Thursday, 10:00 to 18:00 Friday	Harbourside and Easton
Day	10:00 to 18:30	Bedminster and Horfield
Saturday	08:45 to 13:15	Harbourside and Bedminster

Every shift over 6 hours includes an unpaid 30 minute break, taken at a time agreed with the duty manager.

2. Minimum cover

While a clinic is open it must have at least:

- 1 duty manager on site;
- 2 reception staff (1 on Saturdays);
- 1 member of staff trained in fire marshalling.

If cover falls below this, the duty manager tells Isla McGregor straight away. Out of hours, they call the operations on-call phone. If cover cannot be found within 2 hours, the Operations Director decides whether to reduce the clinic's hours.

3. Publishing the rota

- Rotas are published **6 weeks ahead**, every other Friday by 16:00. Isla emails each person their shifts and pins the rota on every clinic's staff room noticeboard. The master copy is kept in the Operations folder.
- Before publishing, Isla checks the rules in section 5 for every person.
- Once published, a rota only changes by a swap (section 4), a leave request approved under section 6, or a cover need decided by the Operations Director.

4. Swaps

1. Agree the swap with a colleague who has the same role and training.
2. Submit the swap request form to Isla McGregor at least 48 hours before the first affected shift.
3. Isla approves or declines it within 2 working days. A swap is not confirmed until Isla approves it.
4. A swap must not break the rest and hours rules in section 5 for either person.

Emergency swaps within 48 hours need the duty manager's approval, and Isla must be told on her next working day.

5. Hours and rest

Rule	Limit
Rest between shifts	At least 11 hours
Rest each week	At least 24 hours in a row, or 48 hours in a row each fortnight
Average weekly hours	No more than 48, averaged over 17 weeks, unless you have signed an opt-out
Saturdays	No more than 1 Saturday in 4 for each person, unless you ask for more
Late shifts	No more than 3 in a row

6. Leave

- Request annual leave at least 4 weeks before the first day off, through the leave form to Isla McGregor.
- No more than 2 people from the same clinic and role can be off at the same time.
- Leave in December is allocated by ballot. The ballot opens on 1 September and closes on 30 September each year.

7. Overtime and bank staff

- Overtime must be approved by the Operations Director before it is worked. Without approval it is not paid.
- Approved overtime is paid at time and a quarter on weekdays and time and a half on Saturdays, or taken as time off in lieu within 8 weeks.
- Bank staff are booked by Isla McGregor only, at least 72 hours ahead where possible.

8. Absence

If you cannot come in, call your clinic's duty manager before 07:00 for an early or day shift, or before 10:00 for a late shift. Do not just send a text. The duty manager records the absence and arranges cover.

9. Contacts

- Rotas, swaps and leave: Isla McGregor, Rota Coordinator, rota@harbourhealth.example
- Cover problems out of hours: operations on-call phone, number on the staff room noticeboard in each clinic
- Overtime approval: Nina Osei, Operations Director